

Bolstering Photography and Video Prompt Construction

Based on an audit of the current PromptMeGood repository (specifically `pmg-visual-studio.js` and `ai.ts`) and current best practices for generative AI media tools (Midjourney, DALL-E 3, Sora, Runway, Kling), here is a strategic breakdown of why the Photo/Video panels currently lag behind the Text panel, and how to fix them.

1. The Current Gap: Text vs. Media

Right now, the **Text** prompt engine is highly robust. It uses a structured payload (`goal` , `category` , `tone` , `format` , `personality` , `avoid` , etc.) and a dedicated system prompt (`SYSTEM_PROMPT` in `ai.ts`) to assemble a comprehensive, multi-layered prompt.

In contrast, the **Photography and Video** panels rely on a much shallower approach:

- **Photography:** The frontend concatenates the user's goal with a few selected pills (e.g., "Cinematic", "Golden Hour") and appends a generic base style string. The backend (`/api/image`) then passes this through a single-pass `IMAGE_PROMPT_ENHANCER` before sending it to the image model.
- **Video:** The frontend concatenates the goal with camera movement and style pills, plus an anti-jitter negative prompt. There is no dedicated backend enhancer for video; it relies entirely on the frontend string concatenation.

The media panels are essentially doing "string addition" rather than structured prompt engineering.

2. Best Practices for Media Prompts

Current industry standards for high-quality image and video generation require a structured, layered approach [1] [2].

Image Prompt Framework (Midjourney, DALL-E 3)

A strong image prompt should be broken down into specific, ordered layers:

1. **Subject:** Who or what is the focus? (e.g., "A 30-year-old woman in a red coat")
2. **Action/Environment:** What are they doing and where? (e.g., "walking down a rain-slicked Tokyo street at night")
3. **Camera/Lens:** How is it shot? (e.g., "Shot on 35mm lens, f/1.8, shallow depth of field")
4. **Lighting:** Where is the light coming from? (e.g., "neon rim lighting, soft diffused key")

light")

5. **Style/Medium:** What is the aesthetic? (e.g., "cinematic photography, Kodak Portra 400 film stock")

Video Prompt Framework (Sora, Runway, Kling)

Video prompts require all the image layers, plus explicit temporal and motion instructions [3] [4]:

1. **Subject & Environment:** (Same as image)
2. **Camera Movement:** How does the camera behave? (e.g., "Slow push in", "Static locked-off shot", "Handheld tracking")
3. **Subject Motion:** How does the subject move? (e.g., "Subject turns head slowly to the left")
4. **Temporal Evolution:** How does the scene change over time? (e.g., "Lighting shifts from afternoon to golden hour as clouds part")

3. Recommendations for PromptMeGood

To bring the Photography and Video panels up to the standard of the Text panel, we need to move from "string concatenation" to "structured assembly."

Recommendation 1: Implement a Structured Media Payload

Update the frontend to send a structured payload to the backend, similar to the text engine. Instead of sending a single `prompt` string, send:

- `subject`
- `environment`
- `camera_angle`
- `lighting`
- `style`
- `motion` (for video)

Recommendation 2: Upgrade the Backend Enhancer

Update `ai.ts` to use a structured system prompt for media, similar to the text `SYSTEM_PROMPT`. The AI should take the structured payload and weave it into a cohesive, highly descriptive prompt that follows the layered frameworks outlined above.

Recommendation 3: Guided Intake UI

The current UI relies on users typing a "goal" and clicking pills. While pills are good, the initial text box is too open-ended. Implement a guided intake (similar to the "Photographer Vision Assistant" found in older `pmg-fixes` scripts) that explicitly asks the user for the Subject, Environment, and Action before applying the pill modifiers.

Recommendation 4: Explicit Negative Prompts

While the current code has some negative prompts (e.g., `--no ugly, deformed`), these should be expanded and categorized. For example, photorealistic prompts need different negative constraints than digital art prompts. Video prompts need strong anti-morphing and anti-jitter constraints.

By adopting a structured, layered approach to both the UI intake and the backend prompt assembly, the Photography and Video panels will produce significantly higher quality, more controllable outputs.

References:

[1]: <https://letsenhance.io/blog/article/ai-text-prompt-guide/> "Let's Enhance. "How to write AI image prompts like a pro [2026]"."

[2]: <https://docs.midjourney.com/hc/en-us/articles/32023408776205-Prompt-Basics> "Midjourney Docs. "Prompt Basics"."

[3]: <https://medium.com/@creativeaininja/how-to-actually-control-next-gen-video-ai-runway-kling-veo-and-sora-prompting-strategies-92ef0055658b> "Creative AI Ninja. "How to Actually Control Next-Gen Video AI: Runway, Kling, Veo, and Sora"."

[4]: <https://letsenhance.io/blog/all/ai-video-camera-movements/> "Let's Enhance. "12 essential camera movements to use in AI video"."